

The new approach to security is about bringing all security systems on to a common platform where they can exchange information and communicate with each other, aiding in the quicker identification of incidents, faster response to threats and in communicating across channels, sectors and boundaries

ness is providing an added boost to the security and surveillance systems industry," informs Sanjeev Sehgal, managing director, Sparsh. The company is one of the few Indian manufacturers of all types of CCTV cameras, DVRs and CCTV accessories. The company is manufacturing more than 150 models of cameras including dome camera, C/CS mount camera, IR camera, etc, which are suitable for various security applications.

Apart from CCTV cameras, the demand for access control devices is also growing. According to Srikanth Pisapati, national sales manager, security products, Matrix Comsec, the companies in security and surveillance sector are expected to register a growth rate of 120 per cent in this current year. "High-quality devices with the complete range of features and backed by high-quality service are in demand, and this will remain so for a very long time. During global recession, this was the only segment that remained unaffected. According to a survey, this industry managed to register an average growth of approximately 80 per cent," he adds. With its manufacturing unit in Vadodra, Matrix Comsec is one of the leading manufacturers of security products and access control devices.

Access control devices include magnetic stripe or wiegand cards, key

cards, motion sensors, push-buttons and switches, flap barriers, boom barriers, catrax, etc. These devices are mainly used at railway platforms, passenger terminals, in corporate houses, premium hotels, stadiums, hospitality industry, gated communities, malls, etc.

The third category—biometrics-based devices—has also experienced stupendous demand. This industry is growing at a CAGR of 23-27 per cent. Today, biometric technologies are being used everywhere. One can see them in operation in posh apartments, hotels, offices, factories, banks, and even in temples. Thanks to improved awareness, the advances in scanning technology leading to cost reduction, and favourable government regulations, biometric technologies have truly arrived and are here to stay.

Though the biometrics market in India is still in its nascent stage, the rapid adoption of this technology for providing enhanced security by both the government and the private sector has opened the floodgates of opportunities for this segment. The Indian biometrics market is currently dominated by devices that use fingerprint recognition technology. Civic bodies have issued fingerprint-enabled ration cards, schools have installed devices that read/recognise fingerprints to keep a check on staff

absenteeism, and several corporate houses use fingerprint biometric systems for physical access control, all of which has led to a huge demand for biometric devices. However, the most ambitious and supposedly the world's largest biometric project—the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)—undertaken by the government, has triggered tremendous demand and opportunity within this segment.

Developing technology

Video surveillance. The concept of modern security systems has changed drastically with the advent of high-technology security cameras. Today, surveillance is not merely about getting information 24x7, but getting relevant information at the right time. With technological advancements, today's network video can pro-actively monitor rather than being merely reactive, as these cameras have inbuilt intelligence that enables them to alert security personnel or activate recording if an untoward incident takes place. However, when compared to countries like the US, Japan and Korea, India is still far behind in this technology.

The surveillance industry is now undergoing a major technology shift—the older analogue-based CCTVs are now giving way to IP-based (digital), Open Source and fully-integrated systems. "The IP-based surveillance camera market is gaining good momentum because of superior technology features and affordability. These devices are therefore preferred over the legacy analogue systems. In India, the surveillance market, which comprises about 30 per cent of the entire security




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